Live BPM Analyzer

Reads the real tempo of a finished song from the audio itself, to two decimal places — and sets the project tempo to it without shifting anything you have already placed.

Suggested shortcut: Cmd + Shift + B

WHAT IT IS FOR

Your grid has to sit on the track, or every cue you place drifts. The tempo printed on a release, or reported by a DJ tool, is usually rounded to a whole number — and a TV edit is often time-compressed by a fraction of a percent on top of that. Half a BPM out over three minutes is several beats of drift by the end.

This reads the tempo out of the waveform and gives you the actual figure.

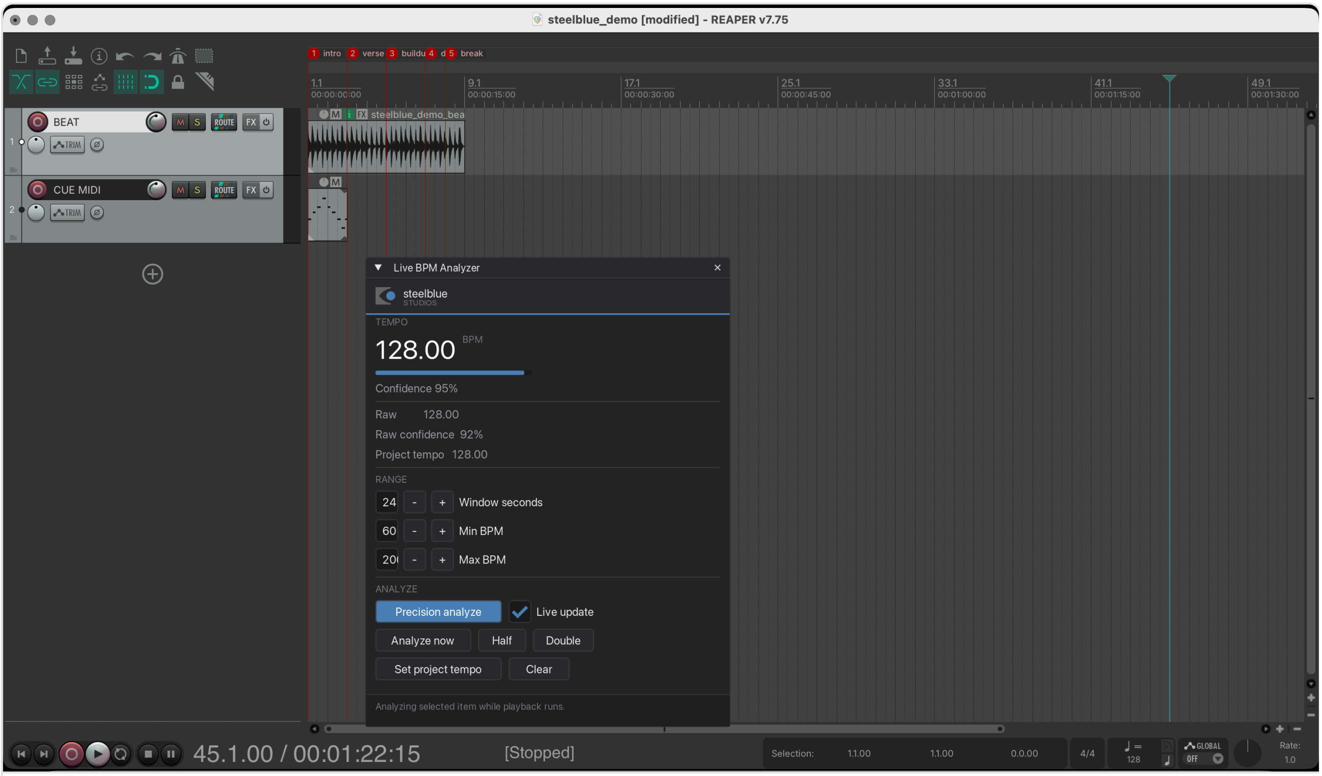
STEP BY STEP

1. **Select the song item**

   Click the audio item in the arrange view. If nothing is selected, the plugin looks for the item under the play cursor.

2 Start the plugin

Press Cmd + Shift + B. It starts reading immediately, updating as playback runs.



Reading a song at 128 BPM. The bar under the number is the confidence.

3 Press Precision analyze for the real answer

Live mode looks at a short rolling window and is meant for a quick glance while the track plays. **Precision analyze** takes up to two minutes of audio out of the middle of the song — skipping intro and outro, where the beat is least reliable — and measures across it.

Live updating switches itself off afterwards, so the result stays on screen instead of being overwritten a moment later.

4 Set project tempo

This is safe to press on a project you have already worked in: every item's position, length and playrate is preserved. Nothing gets stretched or dragged along by the tempo change.

READING THE NUMBERS

Confidence

Confidence answers "how sure am I about *this number*", not "is there music playing". It rewards a clear, steady pulse that stays put over minutes. Roughly:

Above 70 %	A solid, steady beat. Trust the figure.

40–70 %	Usable, but check it against the grid before you build on it.
Under 30 %	There is no reliable pulse here — a rubato passage, an ambient bed, or a section with no drums. The number is a guess.

A produced track with vocals and pads typically lands around 80 %; a bare drum loop goes over 90 %. Noise and free-tempo material sit under 10 %, which is the point of the scale.

Half and Double

Every piece of music is equally "correct" at half and at double its tempo — 65 and 130 describe the same grid, just counted differently. The analyzer picks the musically likely reading, but for half-time material it may land an octave off. **Half** and **Double** are there to correct that in one click, and they keep every decimal place.

When a half or double reading is genuinely almost as strong, a line appears under the status telling you so. If that line stays away, the reading is unambiguous.

Raw versus displayed

The big figure is smoothed over the last few measurements; **Raw** is the latest one on its own. When the two drift apart while a track plays, the tempo itself is moving — a live recording, or a hand-played edit.

GOOD TO KNOW

Window seconds, Min and Max BPM

Leave these alone unless you have a reason. Narrowing Min/Max around a tempo you already suspect helps on difficult material — set 120 to 140 if you know it is house-ish, and the octave question disappears by itself.

What "130" on the label usually means

It usually means "about 130". If your grid drifts on a track that is supposedly a round number, measure it: released material sitting at 130.97 rather than 130.00 is entirely normal, and that difference is worth about seven beats of drift over three minutes.